

Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation Funding Report

Prepared for:

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and

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Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation
204 Draper Rd SW
Blacksburg, VA 24060

Dear Diana Francis,

We're sharing our funding report for the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation. The focus of the report is a list of funders that best match your organization's funding needs, mission, values, and funding priorities. While all are viable funders, we've ranked each of them in order and give a recommendation on the ones more suitable.

Please let us know if you have any questions or information you would like included. Thank you for the opportunity and we look forward to hearing back from you about the funders selected.

All the best,
Hayley Bisek, Riley Bump, Kaitlyn Ellis, and Lucia Lorenz

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Introduction

To find funders for the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation, our team has searched for funders on Candid and FundsNet, as well as the actual websites of each organization. We have identified thirteen potential funders, though some local funders may already be known to the museum. We aim for funders with a history of funding in the 5,000-25,000 dollar range. To find grants for the museum, we focused on those applicable to the Virginia area with a focus on similar values and a history of funding museum and historical artifact projects. We hope the funders described and recommended below offer a good selection of potential funding sources for the museum.

Recommendations

The reasoning behind the order of the funders we deem best fit for the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation mostly concerns the alignment of values and past funded organizations. We looked at every funder and compared who they've funded in the past and how those organizations relate to or appeal to the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation. Based on our research and overall comparison, this is the ranked order of our top six funders from the best to the least best fit:

Ranked Order of Potential Funders

1. Richard S. Reynolds Foundation
2. Dominion Energy Charitable Foundation
3. Weissberg Foundation
4. The Perry Foundation
5. The Lee and Juliet Folger Foundation
6. Herndon Foundation
7. Fidelity Investments Charitable Gift Fund

Richard S. Reynolds Foundation

History

The Richard S. Reynolds Foundation began with Richard S. Reynolds and his wife, Julia Louise Parham, and was inspired by their shared views on the world. Richard S. Reynolds was a revolutionary businessman with an entrepreneurial heart. While working for the R.J. Reynolds Tobacco Company, he invented the moisture-sealed Prince Albert tin, a creation that ultimately led to the development of the Camel cigarette brand.

Later, at the start of World War II, Reynolds shifted his focus and founded the United States Foil Company. This new venture marked a turning point, as he moved away from tin production and began working with aluminum instead. The success of this transition led him to transform his business into the Reynolds Metals Company, which went on to revolutionize the use of aluminum in everyday life, particularly in the kitchen.

Julia Louise Parham, whom Richard met in Bristol, Virginia, had a deep passion for the arts. She dedicated her life to painting, singing, and writing. After their marriage, the two built a life centered around innovation and creativity. When Richard passed away in 1955, Julia established the Richard S. Reynolds Foundation to honor his accomplishments and to carry forward his vision for the future.

Mission

The mission of the Richard S. Reynolds Foundation is to support and strengthen communities for the benefit of future generations by investing in the advancement of education, history, science, health, the arts, and the environment. Their goal is to create a lasting and positive impact on the world around us.

Values

- Strengthening Communities
- Supporting Future Generations
- Anti-Monopoly

Funding Priorities

- Arts
- Education
- History
- Health
- Science
- Environment

Past Funded Organization

Below includes organizations that were awarded funding by The Richard S. Reynolds Foundation that have similar values and missions to BMCF. The most notable organizations are the Ashland Museum, Children's Museum of Richmond, and Louisa County Historical Society. These align most with the museum's efforts and values to preserve history and culture in Virginia.

Name	Location	Amount
2019 Commemoration Inc	Williamsburg, VA	\$100,000
Ashland Museum	Ashland, VA	\$100,000
Colonial Williamsburg Foundation	Williamsburg, VA	\$25,000
Virginia Center For The Creative Arts	Amherst, VA	\$10,000
Children's Museum Of Richmond	Richmond, VA	\$20,000
Louisa County Historical Society	Louisa, VA	\$10,000
Perkinson Center For The Arts And Education	Chester, VA	\$11,200
Swift Creek Mill Theatre Inc	Heights, VA	\$5,000
The Byrd Theatre Foundation	Richmond, VA	\$25,000
Virginia Museum Of Fine Arts Foundation	Richmond, VA	\$25,000
Henrico Education Foundation	Henrico, VA	\$50,000
National D Day Memorial Foundation	Bedford, VA	\$100,000

Application Guidelines

The Richard S. Reynolds Foundation accepts grant requests only from organizations that are tax-exempt under IRS Section 501(c)(3). The foundation does not provide funding for annual or operational expenses, nor does it make grants through fiscal sponsors. While the majority of the Foundation's support has historically been focused in the Greater Richmond area, funding is not strictly limited to that region. Organizations outside the area are welcome to inquire about eligibility. Interested applicants should apply to determine whether they qualify to submit a letter of inquiry or a full grant application. Paper proposals are also no longer accepted.

Dominion Energy Charitable Foundation

History

In 2015, Dominion's charitable arm re-incorporated from an IL trust to a VA non-profit corporation. The organizations did not overlap in operation and had nearly identical Boards. Giving by each entity is broken out by the now-defunct Dominion Foundation and the active Dominion Energy Charitable Foundation. The foundation supports nonprofit organizations through grants for basic human needs, community vitality, and education, including STEM and energy fields.

Mission

Their mission is to fund the future with social, educational, and environmental grants.

Values

- Education
- Community
- Environment
- Arts and Culture

Funding Priorities

- Human Services
- Education
- Environment
- Community and Economic Development
- Arts and Culture

Subject	Amount	Grants	Recipients
Human Services	\$15,456,226	877	1454
Education	\$15,456,226	530	834
Environment	\$12,595,647	322	520
Community and Education Development	\$9,500,688	377	578
Arts and Culture	\$9,464,186	537	314

Past Funded Organizations

The Dominion Energy Charitable Foundation has funded 1,777 grants in Virginia total since 2015. They range from all different types, however, they do include Philanthropy and other

museums. Most notably and relevant to the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation is the Montgomery Museum & Lewis Miller Art Center. This is a local museum in Christiansburg and they received a \$10,000 grant. This shows that they would be willing to give a grant to a local museum since they already have.

Recipient	Location	Amount	Grants
Montgomery Museum & Lewis Miller Art Center	Christiansburg, VA	\$10,000	1
Jamestown Yorktown Foundation Inc	Williamsburg, VA	\$10,000	1
Drew Moss Memorial Foundation	Stafford, VA	\$4,000	1

Application Guidelines

An application form is not required, however, the foundation must submit the following information:

- Copy of current year's organizational budget and/or project budget
- Listing of board of directors, trustees, officers and other key people and their affiliations
- Copy of IRS Determination Letter
- Geographic area to be served
- Detailed description of project and amount of funding requested

Their limitations are as follows: Defined as tax-exempt under section 501(C)(3) of the internal revenue code; within the Dominion operating area; focused on health and human services, education, culture and art, civic and community development, or the environment grants are not made to: individuals; organizations for strictly religious purposes; courtesy advertising in programs, magazines, yearbooks, etc for matching gifts: only gifts from full and part-time employees, current members of the board of directors, and retirees of the company are eligible for matching. eligible organizations include designated 501(c)(3) in the United States and/or registered with the national center for education statistics organizations.

Weissberg Foundation

History

The Weissberg Foundation is a Virginia based foundation started by Marvin Weissberg, a war veteran. He was a founding board member of The National Democratic Institute where he built

numerous relationships with political leaders and activists before finally creating the Weissberg Program in Human Rights at Beloit college in 1988.

He established the foundation to increase impact and understanding of racial injustices and struggles. The founding and early board members were all close friends and family, including his daughters, Nina and Wesley, close friends Marty Heyert, Timmy Napolitano, and Wally Babington, as well as his wife Judith Morris. After four decades, the Weissberg Foundation still reflects Marvin's deep love for humanity and desire to live humbly and full of optimism.

Mission

The Weissberg Foundation's mission is to advocate and help give power to those who are negatively impacted by racial discrimination by changing or dismantling structural systems.

Values

- Community
- Racial Equity and Justice
- Activism
- Optimism
- Education

Funding Priorities

- Human Rights
- Education
- Philanthropy
- Community and Economic Development

Subject	Amount	Grants	Recipients
Human Rights	\$2,386,800	107	39
Education	\$2,167,987	36	19
Philanthropy	\$533,000	14	8
Community and Economic Development	\$1,234,000	65	25

Past Funded Organization

While the Weissberg Foundation has not funded any museums, they have funded Philanthropic organizations interested in education and expansion on African American history and community development. Most notably is the Movement Matters foundation which helps promote, organize, build and educate community developments pertaining to Black, Indigenous, and immigrant communities.

Recipient	Location	Amount	Grants
Movement Matters	D.C.	\$11,000	4
If Foundation	D.C.	\$330,00	1
Greater Washington Community Foundation	D.C.	\$150,00	3

Application Guidelines

The Weissberg Foundation aims to fund power building organizations that are led by and/or accountable to Black, Indigenous, and Communities of Color. This doesn't seem to initially include the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation, however, in advocating for the only piece of African American history still standing in Blacksburg, they fit this category. It aims to recognize and bring awareness to African American history in Blacksburg through further restoring St. Luke & Odds Fellows Hall.

The Perry Foundation Incorporated

History

The Perry Foundation, established in 1946, is a private foundation based in Charlottesville, Virginia. It supports various causes, including youth, education, arts and culture, human services, the elderly, health, and housing. The foundation's mission is to fund local efforts to improve the lives of individuals and communities in the region

Mission

The Perry Foundation's aim has been to transform tragedy into triumph by seeding individual potential, supporting communities, and harvesting sustainable change.

Values

- Human Rights
- Global Sustainable
- Economic Development

Funding Priorities

- Education
- Health
- Agriculture
- Technology

- Arts & Culture

Past Funded Organization

Below include a list of past fund organizations that The Perry Foundation Incorporated has funded that is similar to the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation. Although this foundation has yet to fund any museums, they have funded places that focus on helping artists and education, which the Blacksburgs Museum and Cultural Foundation prioritizes.

Name	Location	Amount
Louisa Downtown Development Corporation Dbas Louisa Arts Center	Lousia, VA	\$30,000
Ronald Mcdonald House Of Charlottesville	Charlottesville, VA	\$10,000
American Frontier Culture Foundation Inc	Staunton, VA	\$5,000
Building Goodness Foundation	Charlottesville, VA	\$15,000
Live Arts	Charlottesville, VA	\$82,500

Application Guidelines

The Perry Foundation, likely referring to the foundation associated with Tyler Perry, does not have a specific application process for a grant focused on Charlottesville, Virginia. While they don't have a direct application process, charities interested in receiving support can explore introducing themselves and sharing their needs.

The Lee and Juliet Folger Foundation

History

The Lee and Juliet Folger Fund was incorporated in 1955 in Washington, DC.

Funding Priorities:

- Arts & Culture

- Community & Economic Development
- Environment
- Philanthropy

Area	Amount	Grants	Recipients
Arts and Culture	\$8,885,500	55	25
Community and Economic Development	\$3,172,500	16	7
Environment	\$1,064,500	21	12
Philanthropy	\$826,000	1	1

Past Funded Organizations

Below are several organizations similar to the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation funded by the Lee and Juliet Folger Fund.

Organization	Location	Amount
The Society of the Four Arts, Inc.	Palm Beach, FL	\$15,000
The National Trust for Scotland Foundation, USA Inc.	Boston, MA	\$10,000
Historical Colony House, Inc.	Lake Wales, FL	\$7,500
McLean Project for the Arts Inc.	McLean, VA	\$5,000

Application Guidelines

The Lee and Juliet Folger Fund contributes only to pre-selected organizations. We have an address and contact info: 1320 Old Chain Bridge Rd, Mc Lean, VA 22101-3956, (703)-847-1350

Fidelity Investments Charitable Gift Fund

History

This public charity is a donor-advised fund that was created in 1991 to connect donors with the ability to donate to subjects close to their hearts with ease. They are a 501(c)(3) public charity that donated “\$14.9 billion to charities in 2024” (Fidelity).

Mission

Their mission is to “further the American tradition of philanthropy by providing programs that make charitable giving simple, effective, and accessible” (Canva).

Values

- Helping connect their donors

Funding Priorities

- Education
- Human Services
- Philanthropy

Subject	Amount	Grants	Recipients
Education	\$10,855,641,465	48885	18877
Human Services	\$6,617,405,963	56226	22159
Philanthropy	\$6,134,190,963	10528	4214
*Arts and Culture	\$2,495,150,480	22343	9138

*Arts and Culture was not the 4th highest subject, it is shown here for comparison as a category that the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation would fall under.

Past Funded Organizations

In Blacksburg between 2019-2023, the Fidelity Investments Charitable Gift Fund has given 50 grants to 22 organizations totaling \$11,370,203. While they are not a fund with a specific charitable purpose to appeal to, they do represent a lot of funders and disperse a lot of grants to a diversified portfolio of nonprofits. Many grants they fund are between 10,000 and 25,000 dollars, with the second largest grouping being 5,000 to 10,000 dollars, so it looks like they are primarily funding within our range. On Fidelity's website they have their 2025 Giving Report linked, which includes an explanation of their fund as a donor-advised fund and gave some statistics about their funding in 2024. The report included that 23 percent of their funded grants were new grants, and nearly 80 percent of grants were repeat grants that had been supported in the past. This has the potential to be a good fund for the Blacksburg Museum and Cultural Foundation, as they do regularly fund new grants, have the potential to be a repeat funder, have in previous years funded locally in Blacksburg, and have a history of funding grants within our range.

Repeat Funds Received in Blacksburg (top 6 most repeated)

Recipient	Location	Amount	Grants
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Virginia Tech Foundation Inc	Blacksburg, VA	\$10,575,404	5
Positive Alternative Radio Inc	Blacksburg, VA	\$104,130	5
St Mary's Roman Catholic Church	Blacksburg, VA	\$76,400	5
New River Land Trust	Blacksburg, VA	\$41,200	5
Northstar Church	Blacksburg, VA	\$265,250	4
HOPE TO WALK	Blacksburg, VA	\$77,230	4

Application Guidelines

An application form is not required. Fidelity Charitable is a private organization that only accepts grants inside of their donation pool. However, getting in appears very doable, and looks to have a high rate of return. The giving account is a donor-advised fund, so donors can recommend grants online, where they are reviewed to make sure they meet grant guidelines. This review makes sure that the charity is IRS recognized, is for charitable purposes, and does not provide additional benefits to donors. The museum meets their eligibility criteria as listed on their website, so if recommended they have a good chance of becoming an eligible grant recipient in their grant pool. Any donor can recommend a grant, and becoming a donor has no minimum initial contribution and no minimum account balance, but does require a 50 dollar minimum grant donation and an administrative fee.

Herndon Foundation

History

Established in 1965 in Virginia, the Herndon foundation primarily funds projects in the metro Richmond area with a preference towards supporting education, human services, and historic preservation. The foundation does have a history of funding in the greater Virginia area, and sometimes outside of Virginia, having funded 11 grants in Bedford Virginia.

Mission

The mission of the Herndon foundation is to provide assistance with education, health and human services, and historic preservation.

Values

- Education
- Community

- Human Services

Funding Priorities

- Education
- Human Services
- Arts and Culture

Subject	Amount	Grants	Recipients
Education	\$12,354,000	187	61
Human Services	\$5,429,000	269	84
Arts and Culture	\$2,401,500	97	38
Community and Education Development	\$2,309,000	91	28

Past Funded Organizations

The Herndon foundation has focused most of their funds in the metro Richmond area, but has funded all along the east coast, from Maine to Florida. Within Virginia, they have funded 557 grants for 194 recipients with funds totaling \$20,425,750.

Application Guidelines

They will open and start accepting applications from August 1st to August 31st via an application link.

The Herndon foundation will require:

- General contact information for the requesting organization.
- Confirmation of 501 (c) (3) status.
- A brief description of the organization, including its mission and history.
- The amount requested and a concise description of the project or request, including specific purposes for which requested funds will be used, and how results will be measured.
- Organization's current operating budget.

Funding Links

[Richard S. Reynolds Foundation](#)

[Weissberg Foundation](#)

[Dominion Energy Charitable Foundation](#)

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